

RepoSkins Free Kit — Setup Guide

Animated profile cards · contribution snake · social badges. Self-hosted, no shared backend, no signup.

Read this first.

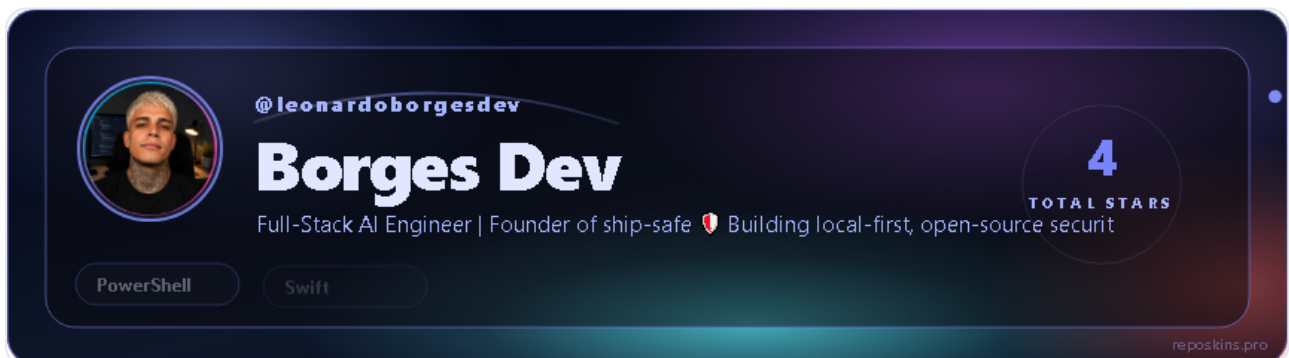
This kit runs entirely on your machine. It calls three services and nothing else: `api.github.com` for your own data (with your own token), `img.shields.io` to build badge images, and GitHub's own Actions runners for the contribution snake. It never calls `reposkins.pro` or `gitskins.com`. Two people running this against the same username get the exact same cards — this isn't generative, it's a template engine, and that's the point: it's meant to be predictable and inspectable.

You need:

Python 3.10+, a GitHub account, and the `gh` CLI (or a classic Personal Access Token, `repo` scope). Budget 10–15 minutes for the first run, most of it waiting on GitHub Actions.

What you get

- **2 free themes** — `midnight` and `github-dark`, both fully themed across every card below
- **8 cards** — hero, wordmark, heatmap, portrait, chess, system-scan, highlights, social-row
- **Contribution snake** — a ready GitHub Actions workflow using [Platane/snk](https://github.com/Platane/snk)
- **Social badges** — shields.io, zero API calls



Real output — @leonardoborgesdev, theme `midnight`. Nothing here is a mockup.

PHASE 1 — Generate the cards

Clone the kit and install the two dependencies (`requests` , `Pillow`):

```
git clone https://github.com/leonardoborgesdev/reposkins.git
cd reposkins
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

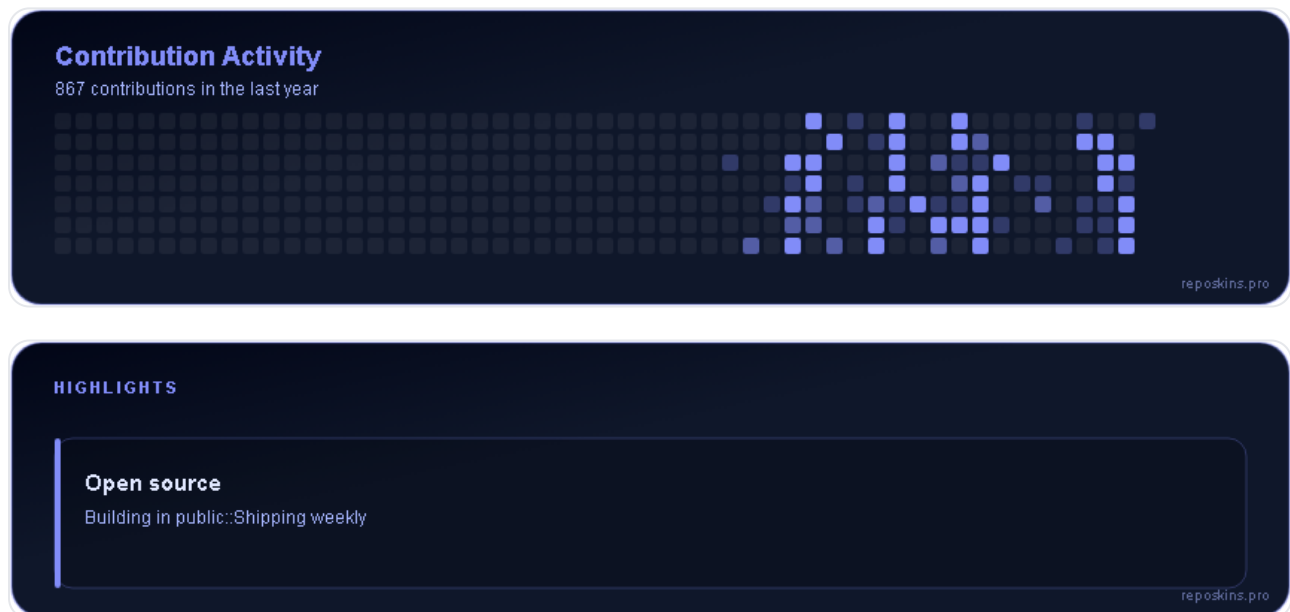
Authenticate and export a token — without this the heatmap card comes back empty (the contribution-calendar query needs one) and you'll hit the public API's 60-requests/hour limit fast:

```
export GITHUB_TOKEN=$(gh auth token)
```

Then generate:

```
python generate.py YOUR_USERNAME --theme midnight \
  --cards hero,wordmark,heatmap,portrait,chess,system-scan,highlights,social-row
```

This writes SVGs to `assets/` and a ready `README.generated.md` .



PHASE 2 — The special profile repo

Create a repo named **exactly** `YOUR_USERNAME/YOUR_USERNAME` — through GitHub's web UI, not the API or `gh repo create` — with "Add a README file" checked.

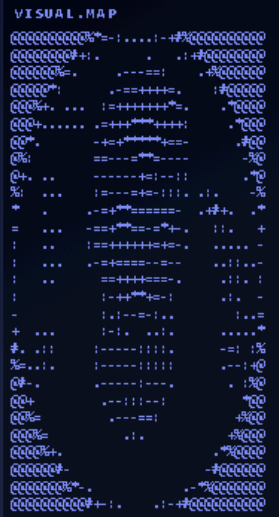
The step everyone gets wrong.

A repo created through the API sometimes fails to trigger GitHub's special profile display, even though it looks identical to one made by hand. If your profile page doesn't show the README after publishing, this is almost always why — delete it and recreate through the website.

Copy `assets/` into the repo root, copy `README.generated.md`'s contents into `README.md`, commit, push.

```
leonardoborgesdev@github ~ $ ./profile-scan --live LIVE
```

VISUAL.MAP



SYSTEM.INFO

Subject
Borges Dev

Handle
@leonardoborgesdev

Bio
Full-Stack AI Engineer | Founder of ship

Repositories
7

Contributions
867

Stars
4

Followers
3

Contact
github.com/leonardoborgesdev

reposkins.pro

Website: https://instagram.com/borges_dew

GitHub: github.com/leonardoborgesdev

reposkins.pro

PHASE 3 — Contribution snake

Re-run with `--with-snake`, then copy `github-actions/snake-midnight.yml` (or the `github-dark` variant) to `.github/workflows/snake.yml` in your profile repo.

Before pushing: **Settings** → **Actions** → **General** → **Workflow permissions** → **Read and write**, on the repository, not your account. Then run the workflow once manually (Actions → Run workflow). The `output` branch — and the snake itself — only exist after that first run finishes green.

If you already publish something else to the `output` branch

(a game GIF, another generated asset), make sure your snake workflow publishes additively — checkout the branch into a worktree, copy just the new files in, commit, push — rather than using a clean gh-pages-style deploy action that replaces the whole branch. The workflow shipped in this kit already does this correctly.

PHASE 4 — Social badges

```
python generate.py YOUR_USERNAME --theme midnight \
  --badges
"linkedin:https://linkedin.com/in/you,instagram:https://instagram.com/you,email:you@example.com"
```

Known bug: LinkedIn.

shields.io only renders the LinkedIn logo on the brand color `#0A66C2`. Any other color and the icon silently disappears, leaving just text. This kit already forces LinkedIn to brand color regardless of your chosen theme — every other logo (Instagram, Gmail, Facebook) recolors fine.

What to expect

Phase	Effort	Iteration?
1 — Cards	3–5 min	Maybe — re-run with a different <code>--cards</code> or <code>--theme</code>
2 — Special repo	2 min	No, but easy to get wrong once
3 — Snake	5–10 min	No — the only wait is the first Action run
4 — Badges	2 min	No — config only

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause	Fix
Heatmap card is empty	No <code>GITHUB_TOKEN</code> set	<code>export GITHUB_TOKEN=\$(gh auth token)</code> before running
<code>rate limit exceeded</code>	Unauthenticated public API, 60 req/hour	Same fix as above
Special profile view never shows up	Repo created via API	Recreate via the web UI , exact name <code>username/username</code>
Image doesn't update on the profile	GitHub's camo cache	Append <code>?v=2</code> , <code>?v=3</code> ... to the image URL
Snake image 404s	<code>output</code> branch doesn't exist yet	Run the Action once manually and wait for green
Snake wiped out other content on <code>output</code>	Workflow used a clean-deploy action	Use the additive <code>worktree-publish</code> workflow from this kit
Action fails pushing with a permissions error	Workflow permissions default to read-only	Settings → Actions → General → Workflow permissions → Read and write, on the repo

What's intentionally not in the free kit

`about` , `stats` , and `stack` cards aren't included — today they only render pixel-perfect in the `midnight` theme even in the hosted product, and shipping a mis-themed card for free felt worse than not shipping it. The other 19 themes and full customization live at reposkins.pro for anyone who'd rather not run anything locally.

— END OF SETUP GUIDE —